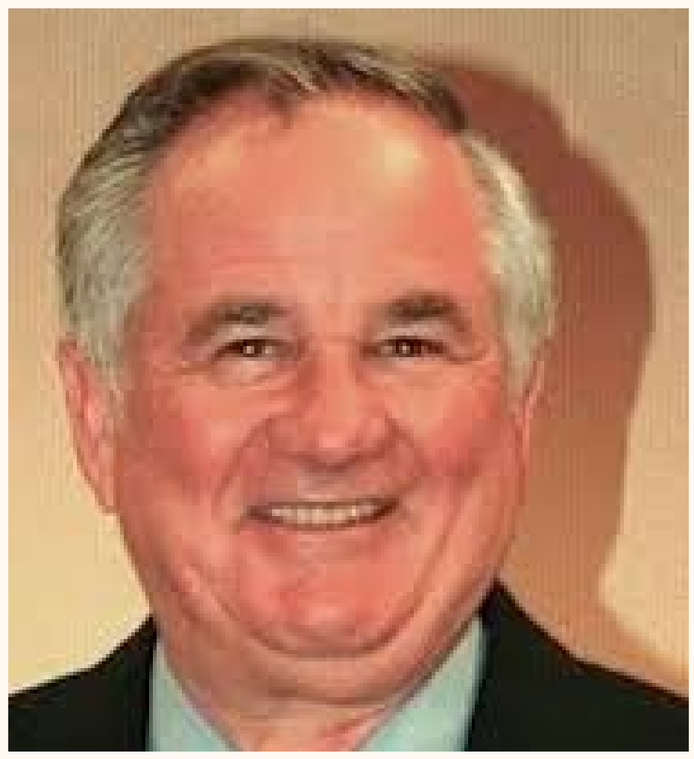
SPENCER KAGAN

INTRODUCTION

Kagan believes that teachers have the ability to shape classroom environments in ways that discourage misbehavior. Kagan's cooperative learning structures are designed to guide how students interact with one another. According to Kagan, the traditional classroom setup often creates competition among students. When one student answers wrong, others may feel a sense of satisfaction because it increases their own chances for recognition. In contrast, Kagan's cooperative structures promote student engagement, encourage positive interdependence, and help minimize disruptive behavior.



WIN - WIN DISCIPLINE OVERVIEW

Spencer Kagan categorized student misbehavior into four types, known as the ABCD of disruptive behavior: Aggression, Breaking rules, Confrontation (power struggles), and Disengagement. To address these behaviors, Kagan, along with Patricia Kyle and Sally Scott, developed the Win-Win Discipline model, which is based on the idea that misbehavior stems from unmet needs. This approach promotes collaboration between teachers and students to establish shared expectations and foster lifelong responsible behavior. Through its five components, the 5 P's: Pillars, Procedures, Positions, Process, and Programs. The Win-Win Discipline helps prevent and manage misbehavior by keeping students engaged and supported in positive ways.

STRATEGY 1

Collaborative Rule-Making:
Involve students in creating classroom rules or "agreements" to build shared responsibility and ownership of behavior expectations (aligns with the "pillars" ideal.)
Ex: In the beginning of the year, lead a discussion where students brainstorm what a respectful classroom looks like. Together, they develop class rules or a social contract to agree to abide by for the yea.r.

STRATEGY 2

Identifying the Student's "Why"
Address misbehavior by identifying the underlying unmet need or emotional "position" that caused it, rather than reacting punitively. (Aligns with positions and process ideal)
Ex. If a students continuously calls out, recognize it as "attention seeks" and give them a classroom job to meet their need.

STRATEGY 3

Preventive Routines
Establish consistent, predictable routines to reduce opportunities for disruption. (Aligns with "procedures" ideal)
Ex. The teacher begins each day with a structured morning routine, greeting students at the door, having them complete a short activity, and reviewing the day's goals.

NOTES

Students misbehave because of one or more seven personal needs or “student positions”. The seven “positions” are attentions seeking, avoiding failure, angry, control seeking, energetic, boredom, and uninformed. Teachers should accept the position but not the behavior. Students should not be blamed for having these positions, they are a part of human nature.

Consequences:

1. Warning
2. Reflection Time
3. Personal Improvement Plan
4. Phone Call
5. Principal’s Office

Classroom Rules

Create rules as a class, collaborate on what kind of rules are fair, discuss-them, model them, implement them once they are mutually agreed upon. The **Win Win Discipline rules** include the ready rule which means come to class ready to learn, the respect rule which means respect the rights and property of others, the request rule which means ask for help when needed, the offer rule which means to offer help to others, and the responsibility rule which means strive to act responsibly at all time.

Preventing Disruptions Before they Start....

Curriculum: Make it interesting and challenging.

Instruction: have students learn and discover together so they are more engaged in the learning process.

Management: have pretention strategies available in the event issues arise.

Cooperative Learning means that students should NOT be seated in rows, they should NOT be quiet, every student needs to be actively engaged which leaves less time for behavior management issues, students work on social skills simultaneously as they explore curriculum together, and instead of a competitive structure (where students hope for classmates to fail) cooperative learning facilitates celebrating one another’s success (“same side”)